

African Voices, *from Carthage to Kampala*

Twenty moves to grow Ochorus's African authorship — new bios, new books and sermons, and more works for the Africans already here — ordered so the public-domain wins come first.

The library is more African than its shelves show.

Nearly a quarter of Ochorus's authors were born, ministered, or have their heritage in Africa — yet the continent is almost invisible in what readers can actually open. This roadmap sets out **twenty concrete moves** to close that gap, grouped in three tracks and ordered so the cheapest, highest-impact public-domain wins come first.

The opportunity is unusually clean because the raw material already exists. The North African church fathers and South Africa's Andrew Murray are long out of copyright and, in several cases, already have an author page and an audience waiting on the site. The import and translation machinery is built. What is missing is not capability but **deliberate acquisition** — deciding which African works to add, and in what order.

Three tracks structure the plan. **Track A** deepens the eight Africans already on Ochorus by giving them their actual books and sermons. **Track B** brings on new African authors — full texts where their writing is free, honour pages where it is not. **Track C** multiplies the reach of everything above through translation into African languages and editorial curation. The single signature move is **importing Samuel Ajayi Crowther's own writings**, which would give Ochorus its first sub-Saharan African books.

THE ONE CONSTRAINT THAT SHAPES EVERYTHING

Ochorus is **public-domain only**. That splits the field cleanly. The richest African **books** are the North African church fathers (Tertullian, Cyprian, Augustine, Athanasius) and South Africa's Andrew Murray — all long out of copyright. Modern revival figures (Kivengere, Nsibambi, Sabiti) can be honoured with **bio pages**, but their writings are still in copyright and cannot be hosted as books. Every recommendation below is filed on the correct side of that line.

Twelve African authors. Four with a book. Zero sermons.

The gap isn't in who is catalogued — it is in what has actually been imported and made readable.

12_{/49} AUTHORS WITH AN AFRICAN BIRTH, MINISTRY OR HERITAGE	4 OF THOSE WHO CURRENTLY HAVE ANY BOOK ON THE SITE	0 SERMONS BY AN AFRICAN AUTHOR, IN ANY LANGUAGE
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Murray · 11 books | Augustine · 1 | Athanasius · 2 | Buyinza · 1 | eight others: bio only

AFRICAN AUTHORS WITH A BOOK TODAY

AUTHOR	ORIGIN	BOOKS	SERMONS
Andrew Murray	South Africa · 1828–1917	11	none
Athanasius of Alexandria	Egypt · 296–373	2	none
Augustine of Hippo	Algeria · 354–430	1	none
Hannah Buyinza	Uganda · contemporary	1	none

The remaining eight — Crowther, Cyprian, Richard Allen, Amanda Berry Smith, Lemuel Haynes and the East African Revival figures among them — carry only a biography. Tracks A and B below turn as many of those bio-only pages as copyright allows into pages a reader can actually open, and the empty sermons column is the plainest single target on the whole site.

Deepen the Africans already on Ochorus

Eight authors are on the site now. Give them their actual books and sermons — the fastest wins, since the import machinery and their audience already exist.

★ FLAGSHIP

01

Give Samuel Ajayi Crowther his own writings

Nigeria (Yorùbá) · 1809–1891 · currently bio-only

public domain

effort medium

impact high

The first African Anglican bishop — freed from a slave ship as a boy, he became a scholar, linguist and missionary statesman — and Ochorus's single most important untapped African author. He would be the site's **first sub-Saharan African with real books**.

His name currently carries only a biography, yet the writings that made him a landmark of the nineteenth-century church are all public domain and simply waiting to be imported — clear first-person English that needs little contemporizing, and the anchor for the whole “African Voices” thread.

Import: *Journal of an Expedition up the Niger* (1841 & 1854), his episcopal *Charges* and addresses, and *Experiences with Heathens and Mohammedans in West Africa*.

02

Expand Andrew Murray from 11 books toward ~20

South Africa · 1828–1917 · 11 books, 0 sermons

public domain

effort low

impact high volume

Ochorus's best-loved author is himself African, and he wrote ~240 works — the import and translate pipelines already know his voice, so each new title is nearly free to add. It is the lowest-friction volume play on the list: no new author record, no fresh bio, and every title is an immediate candidate for the Swahili and Luganda pipelines.

Next tier: *Abide in Christ*, *The Two Covenants*, *The Spirit of Christ*, *The Full Blessing of Pentecost*, *Like Christ*, *Working for God*, *Money*, *The Prayer Life*, *Be Perfect*.

03

Grow Augustine beyond the Confessions

Hippo, North Africa (Algeria) · 354–430 · 1 book

public domain

effort medium

impact high

The towering North African. One book here badly under-represents the man who shaped Western theology more than any figure between Paul and the Reformation. The trick is sequencing: reach for the short, warm, pastoral works first so the shelf grows readable rather than forbidding.

Add the accessible ones first: *The Enchiridion* (Handbook on Faith, Hope & Love), *Ten Homilies on the First Epistle of John*, *On Christian Doctrine*, then selected *Sermons*. Save an abridged *City of God* for later.

04

Round out Athanasius of Alexandria

Alexandria, Egypt · 296–373 · 2 books

public domain

effort medium

impact medium

You already host *On the Incarnation* and his *Life of Antony*, so the author page and audience exist — this is filling out a shelf, not founding one.

Add his devotional gem *Letter to Marcellinus on the Psalms* — a reader-friendly doorway into praying the Psalter — plus *Against the Heathen* and selected *Festal Letters*.

05

Give Cyprian of Carthage his first works

Carthage (Tunisia) · 200–258 · currently bio-only

public domain

effort medium

impact high

A bishop-martyr with a bio but no books. His short treatises are ideal reader-length — a single sitting each — which makes him quick to import and easy to translate.

On the Lord's Prayer, On the Mortality, On Works and Alms, On the Unity of the Church, and selected *Epistles*.

06

Give Richard Allen his autobiography

African-American · founder of the AME Church · 1760–1831 · bio-only

public domain

effort low

impact medium

A foundational voice of the Black church, and his own account of it is short, vivid and entirely free — a low-effort import that turns a bare biography into a reading experience.

The Life Experience and Gospel Labours of the Rt. Rev. Richard Allen, with his *Address to Those Who Keep Slaves*.

07

Give Amanda Berry Smith her Autobiography

African-American evangelist · missionary in Liberia & Sierra Leone · 1837–1915 · bio-only

public domain

effort low

impact high

An Autobiography: The Story of the Lord's Dealings with Mrs. Amanda Smith (1893) is a holiness classic — and eight of its years are a first-hand **West African missionary narrative**, bridging the diaspora and the continent in a single life.

It is the rare book that speaks to two of Ochorus's audiences at once, and it lands cheaply: the full text is public domain and needs no abridgement.

08

Give Lemuel Haynes his sermons

African-American · first Black man ordained in the USA · 1753–1833 · bio-only

public domain

effort low

impact medium

Ochorus has **no sermons by any African author yet** — Haynes breaks that duck. His preaching is compact, argued and quotable, exactly the material the empty sermons shelf needs.

Lead with his famous *Universal Salvation*, plus *The Nature and Importance of True Republicanism* and other collected sermons.

New African authors — bios, and books where they're free

The continent's own catalogue is deep. These names aren't on Ochorus at all yet; most bring genuine public-domain works, and the modern ones bring bios.

★ FLAGSHIP

09

Add Tertullian of Carthage

Carthage (Tunisia) · c.155–220 · new author

public domain

effort medium

impact high

The first great theologian to write in Latin, wholly North African — and conspicuously absent from the library. A major gap to close, and one that visibly strengthens the ancient-Africa cluster the roadmap is building.

Bio + *On Prayer*, *On Patience*, *To the Martyrs*, and the *Apology*.

10

Add Clement of Alexandria

Alexandria, Egypt · c.150–215 · new author

public domain

effort medium

impact medium

Not the Clement of Rome you already host — a distinction worth stating plainly on the page so the two are never confused.

Start with the short, warm *Who Is the Rich Man That Shall Be Saved?*, then *The Instructor (Paedagogus)*.

11

Add Origen of Alexandria

Alexandria, Egypt · c.184–253 · new author

public domain

effort medium

impact medium

His *On Prayer* is one of the earliest and richest treatises on the Lord's Prayer — a natural fit for a library already thick with prayer classics, and a title that reads devotionally rather than as a controversy.

12

Add Macarius of Egypt

Egyptian desert · c.300–391 · new author

public domain

effort medium

impact medium

His *Fifty Spiritual Homilies* shaped John Wesley directly — a ready-made link to the Wesley material already on Ochorus, and deeply devotional in its own right. Cross-linking the two turns an obscure name into a discoverable one.

13

Add Perpetua of Carthage

Carthage (Tunisia) · martyred 203 · new author

public domain

effort low

impact high

The Passion of Perpetua and Felicity preserves her prison diary — the **earliest surviving writing by a Christian woman**, and it is African. A short, unforgettable read that also adds a woman's voice to the ancient set.

Low effort, high resonance: it is brief enough to import in an afternoon, and it opens the reading plan on a note no other library can match.

14

Add the Desert Fathers of Egypt

Egyptian desert · 3rd–5th c. · new author/collection

public domain

effort medium

impact medium

Antony the Great already appears through Athanasius's *Life*; give him his own page with the *Letters of Antony*, and add a curated *Sayings of the Desert Fathers* selection — the seedbed of Christian monasticism, entirely African.

15

Add the Black women preachers of the holiness tradition

African-American · 19th c. · new authors (a cluster)

public domain

effort medium

impact high

An underrepresented seam of vivid spiritual memoir, and one that pairs naturally with Amanda Smith to give the diaspora a chorus rather than a single voice. Bios + full texts, all free.

Jarena Lee (*Religious Experience and Journal*), **Julia A. J. Foote** (*A Brand Plucked from the Fire*), and **Zilpha Elaw** (*Memoirs*).

16

Add the AME founders around Richard Allen

African-American · late 18th–19th c. · new authors

public domain

effort low

impact medium

Completing the founding generation of the independent Black church alongside Allen turns a single entry into a coherent movement readers can follow.

Daniel A. Payne (*Recollections of Seventy Years*) and **Absalom Jones** (*A Thanksgiving Sermon*, 1808).

17

Build the East African Revival as a bio cluster

Uganda, Rwanda, South Africa · 19th–20th c. · bios only

in copyright → bio only

effort low

impact medium

Deepen the pages you already have (Kivengere, Nsibambi, Sabiti) and add **Apolo Kivebulaya**, **William Wadé Harris**, **Bernard Mizeki**, and **Tiyo Soga** — the first ordained Black South African, who translated *Pilgrim's Progress* into Xhosa (a lovely tie to a book you already host).

These are honour pages, not book pages — their own writings remain in copyright. Say so plainly on each.

Multiply the reach of everything above

Content is only half the goal — these three moves put African voices in front of African readers, in their own languages.

18

Translate African authors into your African languages

Swahili & Luganda — already live on Ochorus

effort low-medium

impact high

You already run **sw** and **lg**. Push Murray, Crowther, Augustine and Cyprian through the translate-book pipeline into both — African works, read by African readers, in African languages.

The content from Tracks A and B is the raw material here; this is the move that turns a growing shelf into genuine reach on the continent itself.

19

Open new African target languages — and staff the review gate

Hausa · Yorùbá · Amharic · Zulu/Xhosa · French

effort medium

impact high

The Language registry takes a new language from the admin with **no deploy**. The real bottleneck isn't machine translation — it's **native review** to lift **ai_unreviewed** to approved.

Recruiting African reviewers is therefore the highest-leverage non-code move on this list: it is the one step that lets everything else ship as trustworthy, native-checked text rather than a badge of caution.

20

Curate and merchandise an “African Church” thread

Collection page · reading plan · quotes · covers

effort low-medium

impact high

Tie it together so readers discover it: an **African Voices** collection and a reading plan — *From Carthage to Kampala* — threading Perpetua → Cyprian → Augustine → the Desert Fathers → Crowther → the Revival.

Then grow each author's quote page and commission covers, so these voices surface on the homepage and in search rather than waiting to be looked up by name.

Where I'd start this week

Highest impact, lowest cost: #2 (more Murray — pure volume, machinery ready), #7 (Amanda Smith's autobiography — a diaspora-to-Africa bridge), and #13 (Perpetua — short, striking, and it adds a woman's voice to the ancient set).

The signature move: #1 — Crowther's own writings would give Ochorus its first sub-Saharan African books and anchor the whole "African Voices" thread.

Appendix • Public-domain source works named in this roadmap

Every title below is out of copyright and importable today; the copyright-bound Revival figures (item 17) are deliberately absent — they are honour pages, not books.

Samuel Ajayi Crowther	Journal of an Expedition up the Niger (1841 & 1854); episcopal Charges & addresses; Experiences with Heathens and Mohammedans in West Africa
Andrew Murray	Abide in Christ; The Two Covenants; The Spirit of Christ; The Full Blessing of Pentecost; Like Christ; Working for God; Money; The Prayer Life; Be Perfect
Augustine of Hippo	The Enchiridion; Ten Homilies on the First Epistle of John; On Christian Doctrine; selected Sermons; an abridged City of God
Athanasius of Alexandria	Letter to Marcellinus on the Psalms; Against the Heathen; selected Festal Letters
Cyprian of Carthage	On the Lord's Prayer; On the Mortality; On Works and Alms; On the Unity of the Church; selected Epistles
Richard Allen	The Life Experience and Gospel Labours of the Rt. Rev. Richard Allen; Address to Those Who Keep Slaves
Amanda Berry Smith	An Autobiography: The Story of the Lord's Dealings with Mrs. Amanda Smith (1893)
Lemuel Haynes	Universal Salvation; The Nature and Importance of True Republicanism; collected sermons
Tertullian of Carthage	On Prayer; On Patience; To the Martyrs; Apology
Clement of Alexandria	Who Is the Rich Man That Shall Be Saved?; The Instructor (Paedagogus)
Origen of Alexandria	On Prayer
Macarius of Egypt	Fifty Spiritual Homilies
Perpetua of Carthage	The Passion of Perpetua and Felicity
Desert Fathers	Letters of Antony; a curated Sayings of the Desert Fathers
Black women preachers	Jarena Lee — Religious Experience and Journal; Julia A. J. Foote — A Brand Plucked from the Fire; Zilpha Elaw — Memoirs
AME founders	Daniel A. Payne — Recollections of Seventy Years; Absalom Jones — A Thanksgiving Sermon (1808)